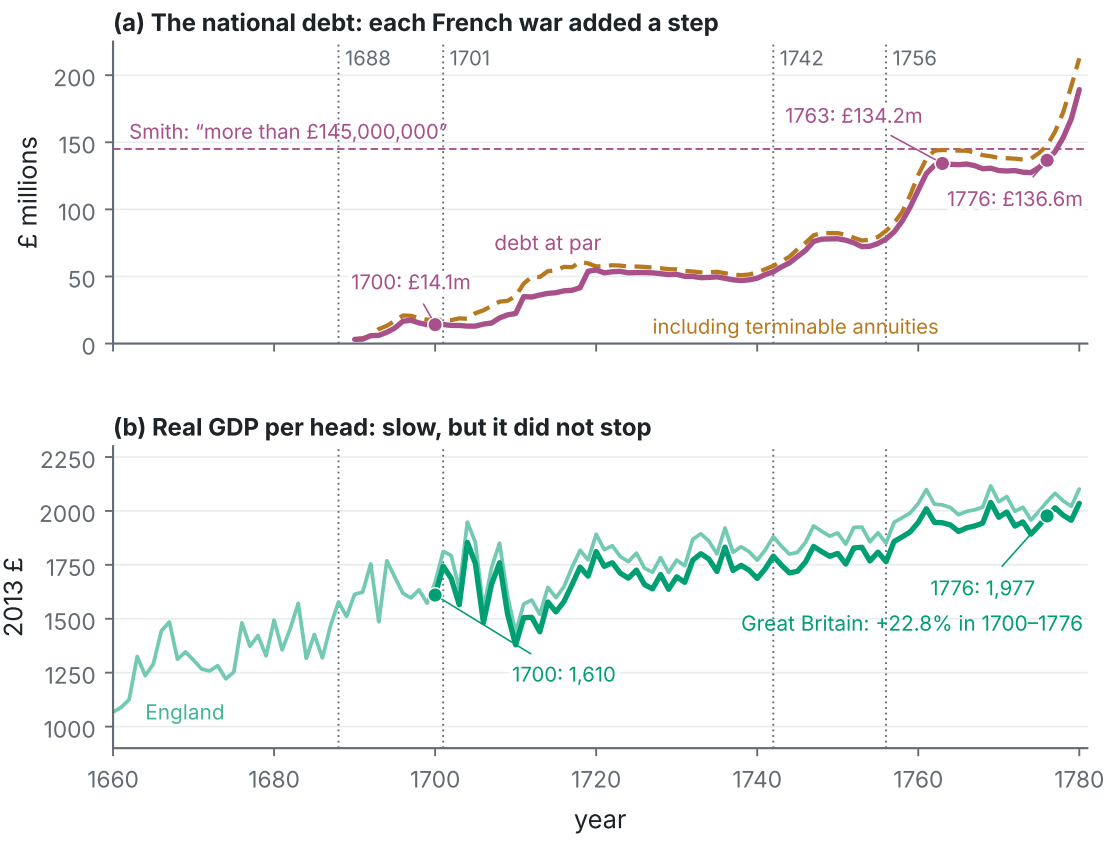
(a) The national debt: each French war added a step
1688
1701
1742
1756
200
150
100
50
0
£ millions
Smith: "more than £145,000,000"
1763: £134.2m
1776: £136.6m
debt at par
1700: £14.1m
including terminable annuities
(b) Real GDP per head: slow, but it did not stop
2250
2000
1750
1500
1250
1000
2013 £
1776: 1,977
Great Britain: +22.8% in 1700–1776
1700: 1,610
England
1660
1680
1700
1720
1740
1760
1780
year